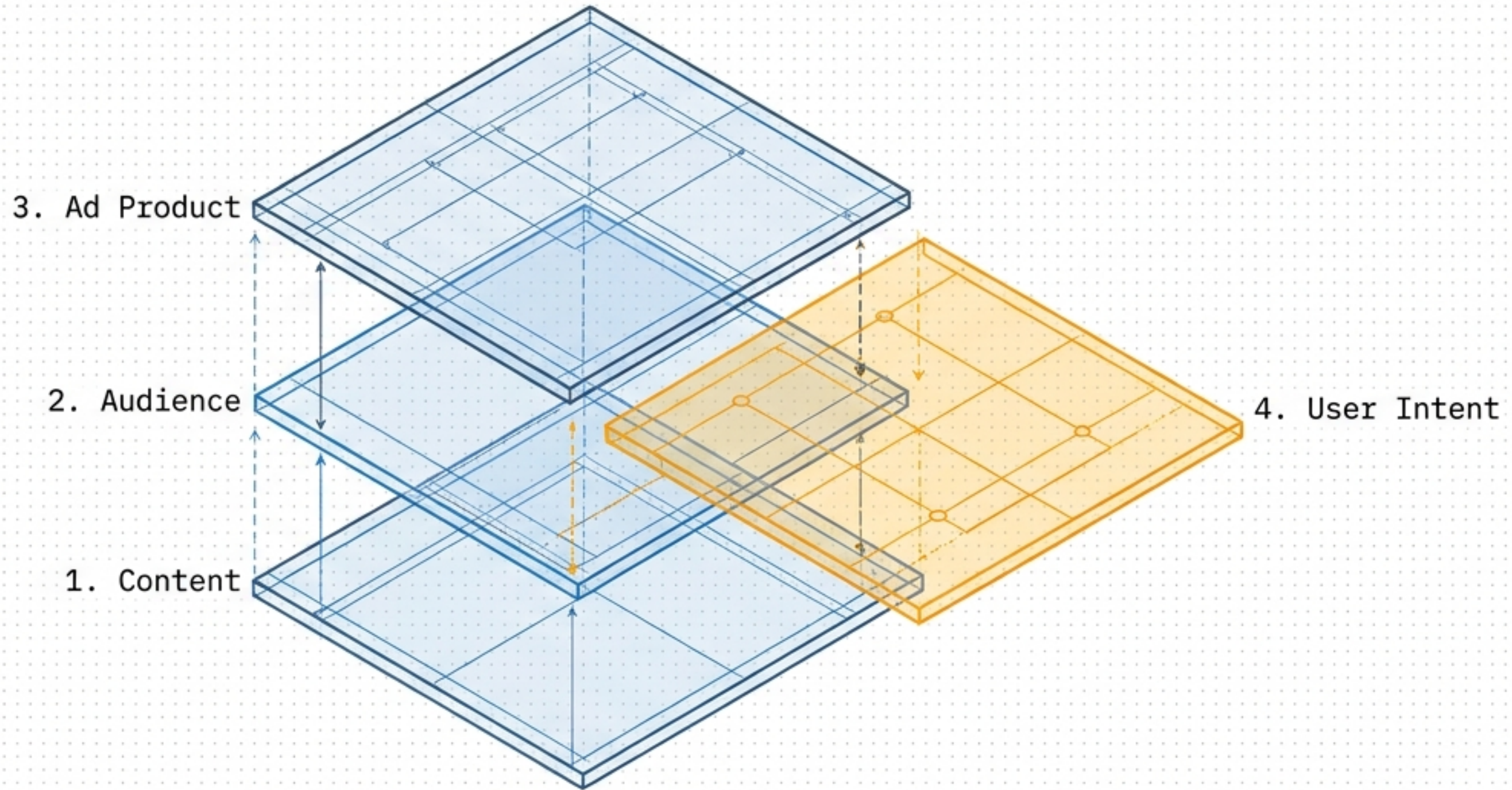
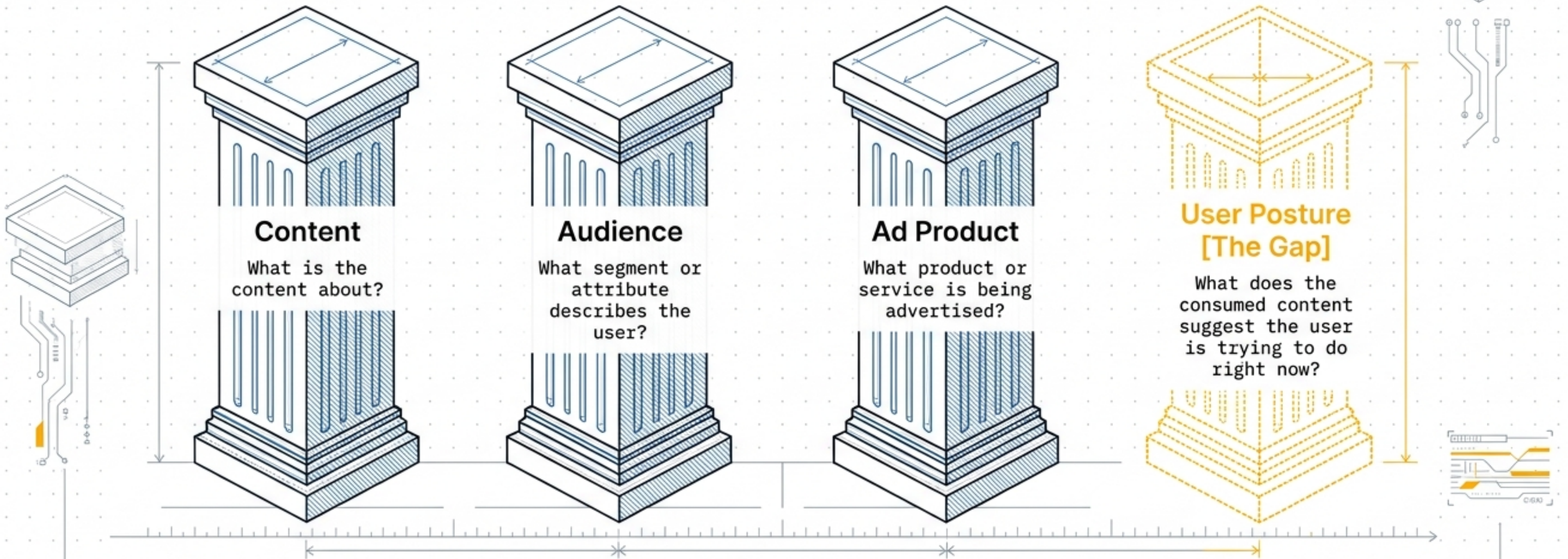


The Missing Layer: Standardizing User Intent

A proposal for an interoperable User Intent Taxonomy family to standardize inferred posture across the ad-tech ecosystem.

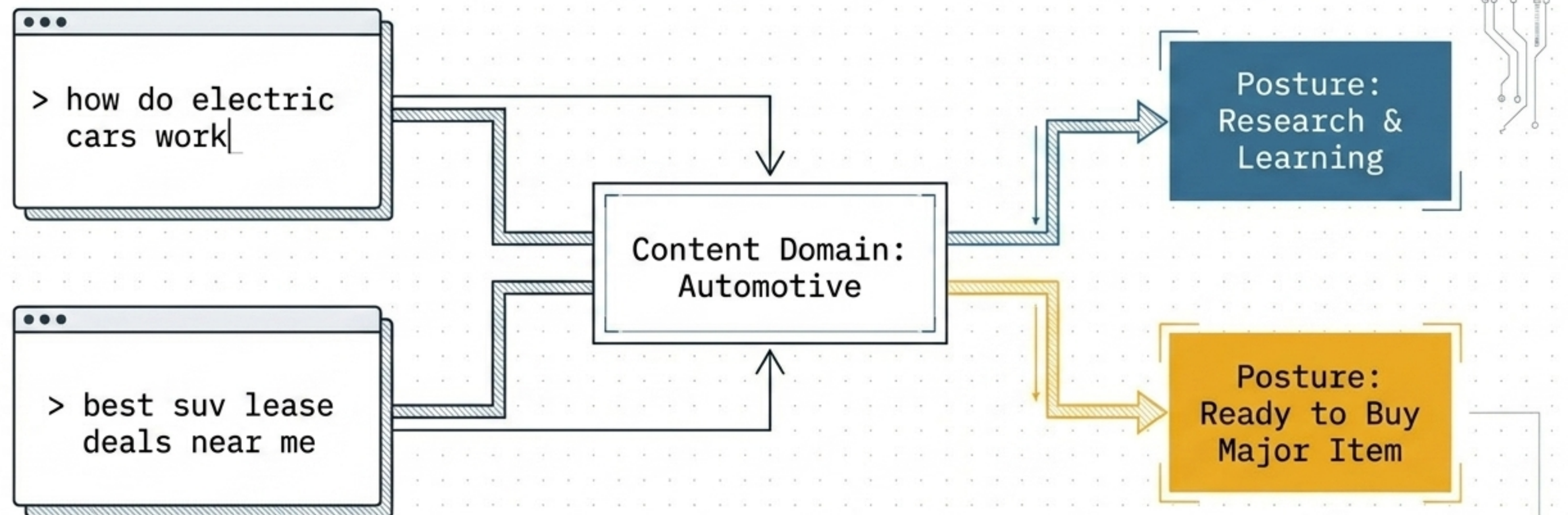


The Industry Standardizes Three Dimensions. It Misses the Fourth.



Without a shared language for posture, the industry relies on inconsistent, fragmented, and proprietary logic to distinguish research from transaction readiness.

The Crucial Distinction: Topic $\neq$ Intent



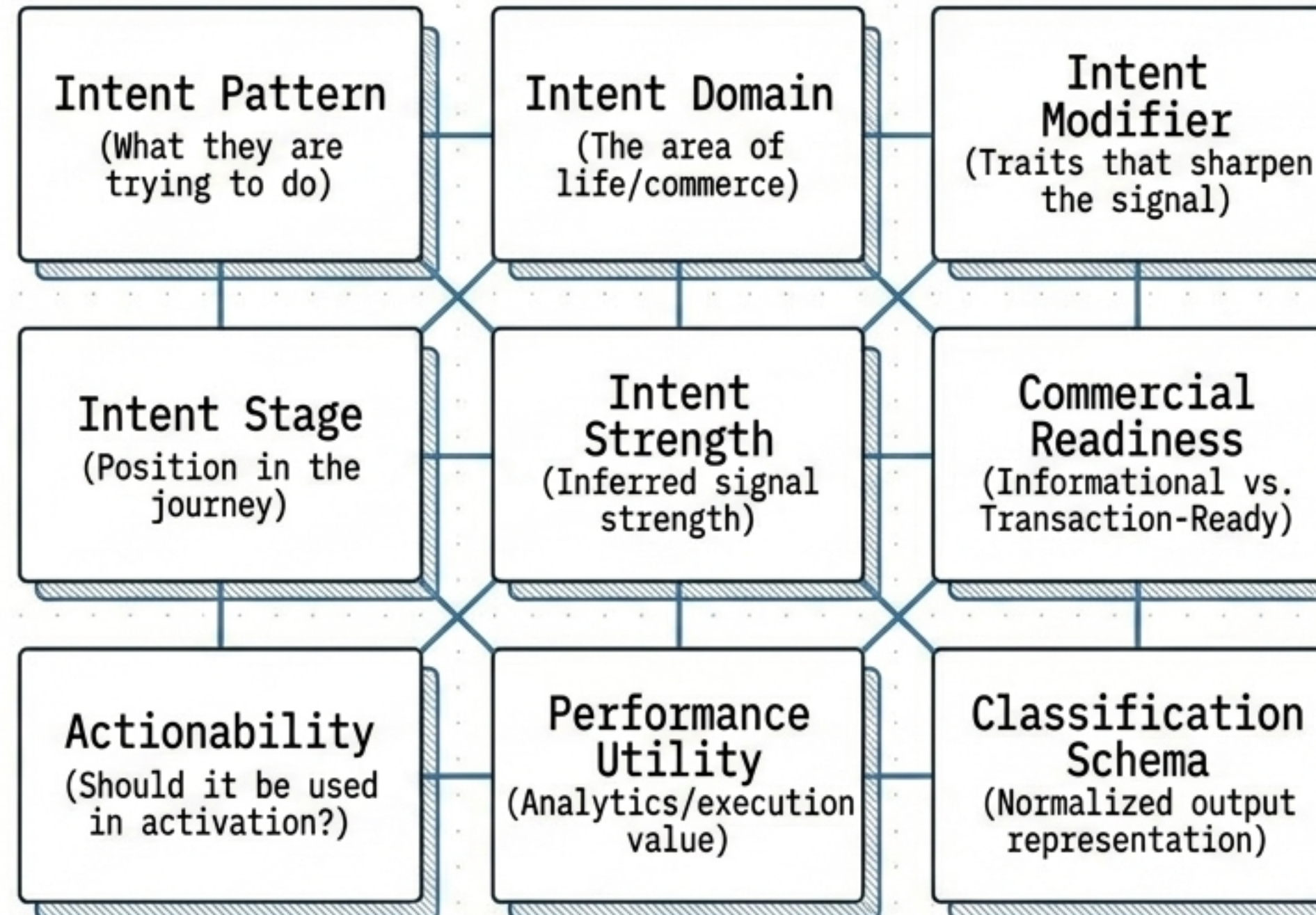
Two records can share an identical topic domain and still imply vastly different user posture. Topic alone hides commercial and behavioral differences that matter operationally for activation, packaging, and ML classification.

Alignment, Not Redundancy: A Distinct Semantic Job

Taxonomy Family	Primary Question	Unit of Application	Core Strength
Content	Aboutness	Pages / URLs	Subject Matter
Audience	Who is the user?	Profiles / Segments	Stable Demographics & Interests
Ad Product	What is advertised?	Creatives	Offer Classification
User Intent [NEW]	What is the implied posture?	Immediate events / snippets	Near-term behavioral likelihood

User Intent is an additive taxonomy. It complements existing frameworks rather than replacing them.

The Proposed Solution: A Modular, Multi-Dimensional Framework



By separating behavior from domain, and operational controls from semantic labels, the modular design allows for independent evolution and explicit implementation choices.

Anatomy of a Classified Record

Input: best suv lease deals near me

Flat Metadata Tag

Topic: Automotive

Incomplete operational posture.

Multi-Dimensional User Intent Record

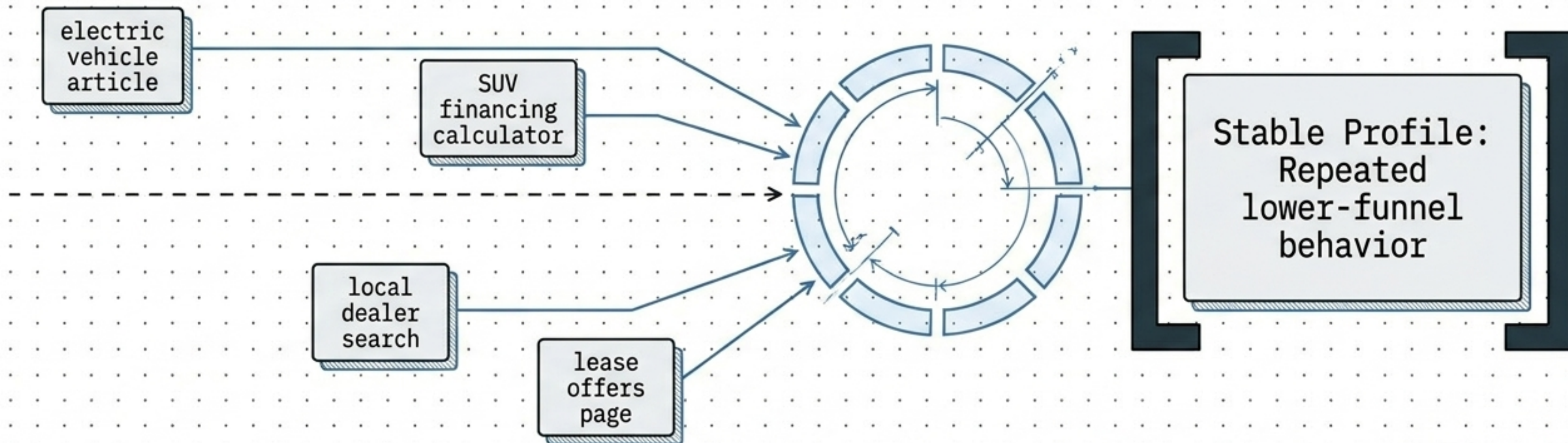
```
{  
  "Intent Pattern": "Ready to Buy Major Item",  
  "Intent Domain": "Automotive",  
  "Intent Modifiers": ["Deal Seeking", "Local", "Urgency"],  
  "Intent Stage": "Ready to Act",  
  "Commercial Readiness": "Transaction Readiness",  
  "Actionability": "Eligible",  
  "Performance Utility": "High"  
}
```

A multi-dimensional record expresses precise operational posture, breaking free from the limitations of generic funnel labels.

Event-First Posture Drives Derived Profiles

Micro: Immediate, isolated page/snippet classification

Macro: Downstream profile aggregation



While inherently an event-first classification system, repeated, high-confidence intent signals safely and structurally power derived user-profile mappings.

Strict Classification Boundaries: What This is **NOT**

NOT an Identity System

It infers posture from content,
not demographic reality.

NOT a Replacement

It does not deprecate IAB
Content, Audience, or Ad
Product taxonomies.

NOT an Eligibility Determiner

It makes no medical, financial,
or insurance eligibility
determinations.

NOT a Policy Engine

It describes metadata; platform
enforcement policy still
dictates ultimate usage.

Built-In Safeguards and Operational Controls

! Actionability Controls

Built-in metadata flags separate reporting-only use from activation-eligible signals. Useful does not mean unrestricted.

[META_FLAG: REPORT_ONLY]
[META_FLAG: ACTIVATION_ELIGIBLE]
...
STATUS: RESTRICTED
SIGNAL_TYPE: REPORTING

! Sensitive Domains

Native, strict monitoring flags for health conditions, debt/financial distress, and legal vulnerabilities.

[FLAG: HEALTH_CONDITION]
[FLAG: FINANCIAL_DISTRESS]
[FLAG: LEGAL_VULNERABILITY]
STATUS: STRICT_MONITORING
DOMAIN_TYPE: SENSITIVE

! Derivation Constraints

Profile derivation is governed by more conservative, strong-confidence thresholds compared to one-off event labeling.

[THRESHOLD: STRONG_CONFIDENCE]
[CONSTRAINT: CONSERVATIVE]
[DERIVATION_RULE: HIGH_CONFIDENCE_ONLY]
EVENT_LABELING: STANDARD_THRESHOLD
STATUS: CONSTRAINED

Addressing the Skeptics: Overlap & Redundancy

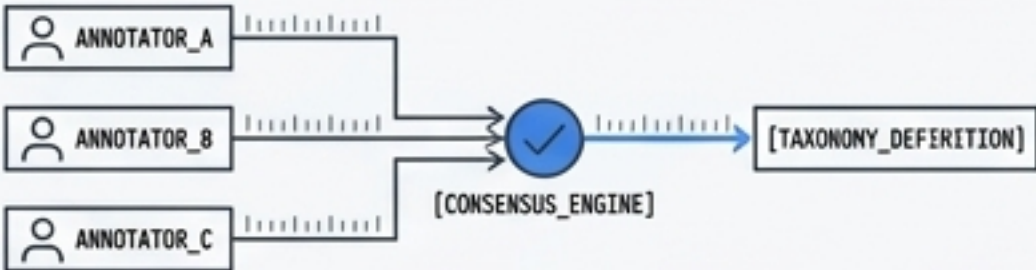
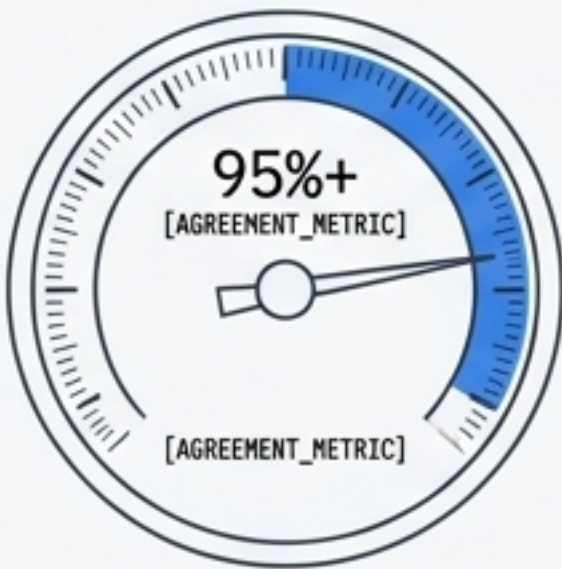
Risk & Mitigation Ledger		
The Reviewer Question	The Underlying Concern	The Structural Reality
Isn't this just Audience Taxonomy purchase-intent?	Duplicating segment language.	Audience labels stable attributes. Intent labels immediate event posture. They map, but remain distinct layers.
Why not just use new mapping guidance?	Adding unnecessary structural complexity.	Inconsistent proprietary logic causes operational failure; standardizing the vocabulary forces ecosystem-wide consistency.
Are mappings authoritative or illustrative?	Fear of forced pipeline overhauls.	First-pass crosswalks are provided to ensure rapid ecosystem integration without overhauling existing pipelines.

Addressing the Skeptics: Empirical Validation

The Concern: Can independent implementers reproduce the same output across varying ML classifiers?

Validation Checkpoint

Tested Annotator Alignment



Tested Annotator Alignment

Taxonomy definitions driven by rigorous, multi-annotator validation across diverse verticals.

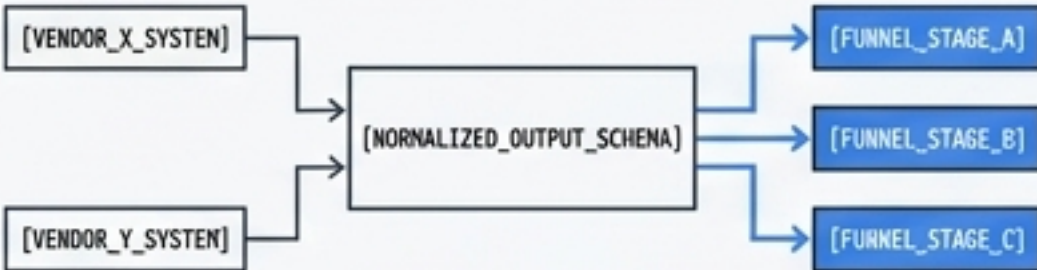
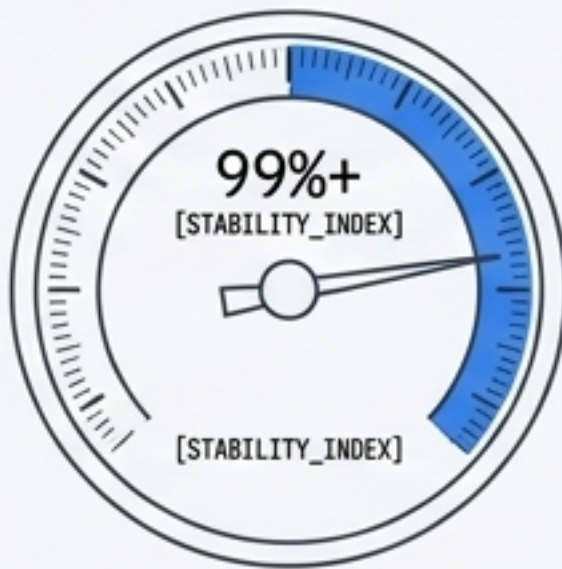
Ambiguity Reduction



Ambiguity Reduction

Specifically engineered to handle mixed-intent edge cases and editorial content with weak commercial posture.

Classification Drift Prevention

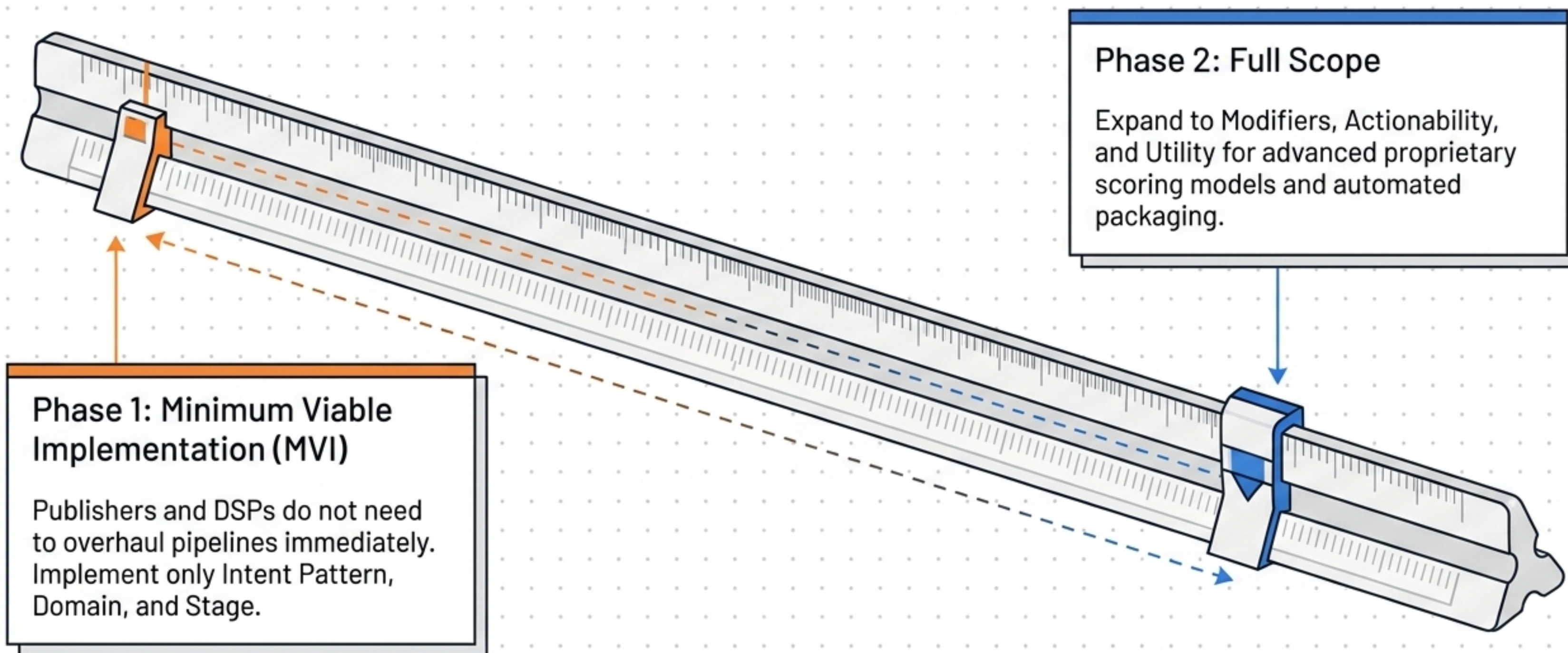


Classification Drift Prevention

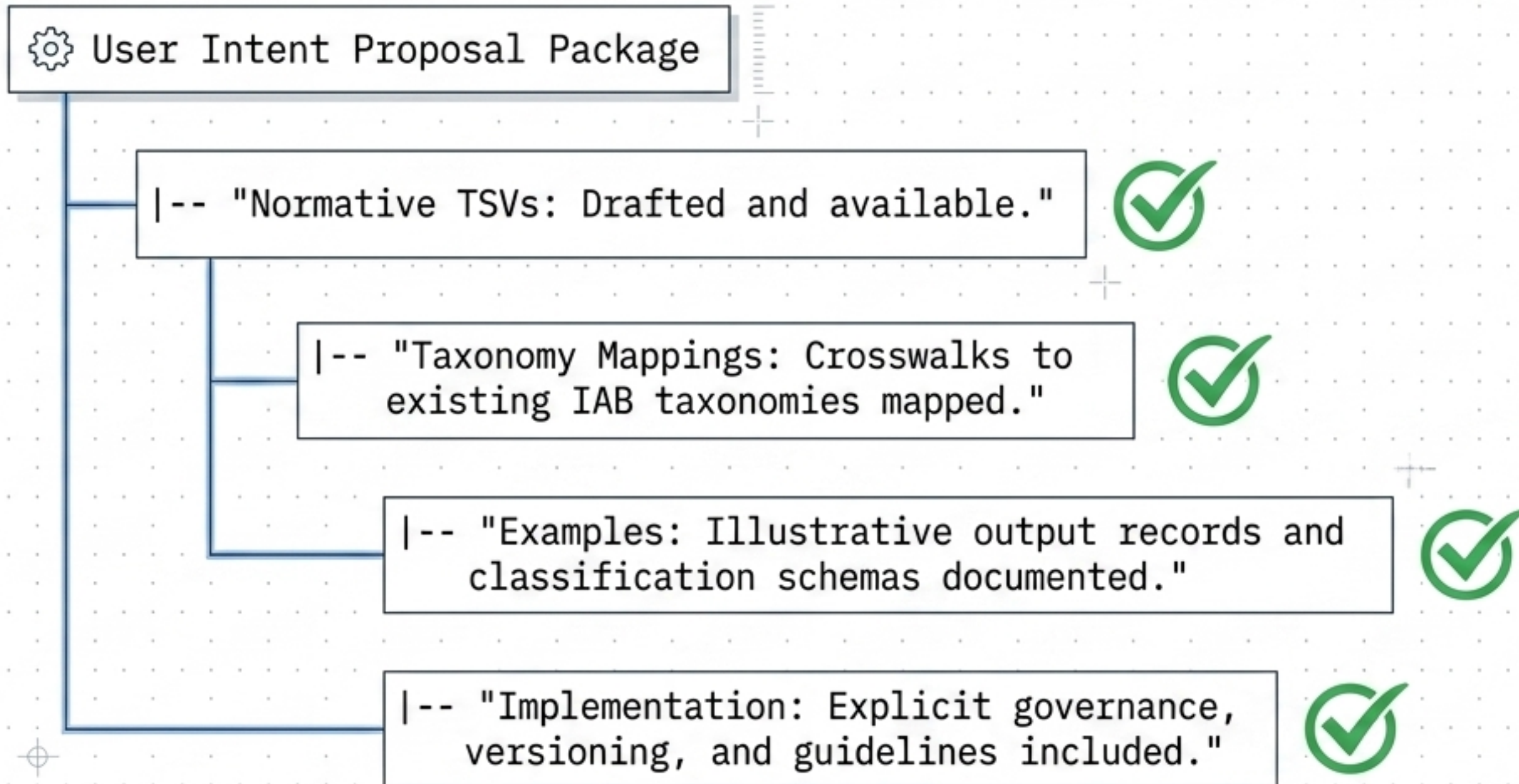
Normalized output schemas prevent vendors from mapping identical content to contradictory funnel stages.

Incremental Adoption and Implementation Burden

The Objection: Is a 9-dimension multi-file taxonomy too complicated for broad ecosystem adoption?



A Proposal-Ready Interoperability Standard



This is not a conceptual whiteboard sketch. The package contains the normative assets required for formal IAB evaluation and ecosystem adoption.